

World Bank Study Guide

Agenda

Structural underrepresentation of the Global South in Bretton Woods institutions

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Committee Mandate:

The World Bank is guided by the Articles of Agreement as the founding legal document. The two most important arms of the Bank are:

1. IBRD (International Bank for Reconstruction and Development)
2. IDA (International Development Association)

IBRD assists in the reconstruction and development of member territories, promotes private foreign investment, promotes long-range balanced growth of international trade, and maintains balance of payments. It mainly lends to middle-income and creditworthy lower-income countries. IBRD gives near-market interest rates, since it raises most of its money by borrowing on international capital markets (backed by member government capital) rather than getting donations

The IDA is the Bank's concessional-lending arm and was created specifically because IBRD's market-rate model didn't work for the poorest countries. Thus, one of the main aims was to provide financing on more flexible terms to the poorest developing countries to reduce poverty. Its terms were light, ranging from zero or very low interest; long grace periods, 30-40 year repayment terms, and increasingly outright grants for the most debt-vulnerable countries

The Non-Political Clause - Article IV, Section 10 ("Political Activity Prohibited") states that the bank should not and can not base its decision on political incentives, and the debate should always and only be based on economic principles. This also meant to protect the Bank's own creditworthiness: if it were seen as politically motivated, investors buying Bank bonds might see it as a riskier, less neutral actor. The three ways the Bank can lend: direct loans from its own capital, loans from funds it borrows on capital markets, or guaranteeing private investor loans.

Core instruments it actually has:

1. Approve/reject/modify loans and grants
2. Attach conditionality (policy reform requirements) to lending
3. Set interest rates and repayment terms
4. Issue influential reports/rankings (World Development Report, formerly Doing Business)
5. Provide technical assistance/advisory alongside loans

What it does NOT have power to do:

1. No enforcement/coercive power (no sanctions regime, no military capacity - unlike UNSC)
2. Cannot unilaterally cancel debt without borrower/creditor coordination
3. Cannot override a sovereign government's domestic law ,only leverage is withholding/conditioning funding

Introduction to the agenda:

Following the aftermath of World War II, the Bretton Woods institutions were created, which included mainly the World Bank and the International Monetary Fund (IMF). These institutions are referred to as the Bretton Woods Institutions because they were formed at the Bretton Woods Conference in Bretton Woods, New Hampshire, USA, back in 1944. The IMF was created with the purpose of helping countries stabilize after World War II by providing them loans and financial support, while the World Bank mainly aimed to support the financial development of countries through development loans, technical guidance, and helping reduce poverty in countries.

These institutions have over the years strongly influenced many economic policies, including the conditions for countries taking loans from the IMF. While it is true that countries themselves agree to the terms of a loan, for many countries, they do not have many options or alternatives other than the conditions imposed by the IMF. Currently, the countries that affect their economic policies for them are mostly the developed countries, which have significantly more voting rights than the underdeveloped countries.

The World Bank regularly hosts annual meetings and spring meetings to discuss any issues and there is a proper voting system in place for decisions. It is important to note that any country which is a part of the World Bank is allowed to attend these meetings and take part in the discussions as well, however, not all countries have equal voting power. The general principle behind the voting system is basic votes which a country obtains by simply being a part of the World Bank, and share votes which a country obtains based on factors like the country's economy and financial contribution to the World Bank. This means that countries with a stronger economy generally have more voting power and hence better representation in the World Bank's decision making.

Key terminologies

World Bank:

The World Bank was founded in 1944 as a means to support development in countries around the world. The World Bank does not fall under the United Nations and operates as a separate entity. The World bank can provide loans for rural development, any construction projects,

support for healthcare and education, technical expertise and advice on economic policy of a country.

IMF:

The International Monetary Fund (IMF) was also founded in 1944 mainly to help stabilize countries after the devastation caused by the second world war

Global South:

The global south is a general term used to describe countries that are underdeveloped or developing and mostly lie in the regions of Asia, Africa, Latin America, middle east and parts of Oceania

Global North:

The global north is the complete opposite of global south and this refers to developed and generally wealthier countries

Capital subscription:

Basic votes:

These are the votes in the world bank annual and spring meetings that every country obtains by simply being a part of the world bank and in comparison to share votes these basic votes are way less in number

Share votes:

These are exclusive votes for countries given based on factors like a country's GDP and its financial contribution to the World Bank. These votes form the majority of the world bank's votes

The World Bank Group (WBG):

This is a group of five institutions within the World Bank that mainly work towards development and reducing poverty in countries. This group consists of International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (IBRD), International Development Association (IDA), International Finance Corporation (IFC), Multilateral Investment Guarantee Agency (MIGA), and International Centre for Settlement of Investment Disputes (ICSID).

Capital Subscription:

Capital subscription is the amount of money a country is willing to give to the World Bank on an annual basis and capital subscription is one of the most important factors in deciding how many share votes a country gets.

Board of Governors:

This is the highest governing body for the World Bank and this board consists of a governor and alternate governor appointed by each country which is a part of the world Bank and these

individuals are usually senior government officials or finance ministers. These people then hold meetings together and form councils to make decisions involving the World Bank.

General Capital Increase:

General Capital Increase is an ordeal given by the World Bank that authorizes countries to give more capital to the World Bank effectively increasing the World Bank's overall capital to work with which can help in increased loans and better and helping countries during major crisis situations.

Background behind the creation of Bretton Woods Institutions:

Economic problems have been rising in this world since all the way back in 1929 when the great depression began. As the US stock market crashed a widespread panic began and it led to a domino effect where banks collapsed leading to many people losing their savings and credits in banks additionally, businesses seeing the increasing economic crisis laid back operations and hence hundreds of thousands of people lost their jobs leading to a dramatic surge in unemployment. This event did not directly influence the creation of the IMF and the World Bank, however indirectly more than anything it showed the world that new and stronger economic reforms and policies were needed to prevent such an event from repeating itself.

In 1939 however as Germany invaded Poland the second world war started which became one of the deadliest wars in the history of mankind. As countries saw harsh fighting many countries suffered huge economic losses as their infrastructure collapsed and industries shut down leading to widespread poverty and economic collapse especially in the countries which saw direct fighting. So in 1944 as the war was close to its end the countries realized that a financial body was desperately needed to provide loans and aid in order to rebuild the collapsed infrastructure and economies of the war ridden countries. Hence in the Bretton Woods Conference 1944, Representatives from 44 allied countries gathered together in New Hampshire USA to design a new international financial body and hence through the discussions the IMF and the World Bank were formed. This is also the time period when countries invested capital into the World Bank in order to set up their shares and get share votes on that basis. From that time up until now change in share votes has been very minute despite countries like China now heavily investing in the World Bank.

Timeline for events following the creation of the Bretton Woods Institutions:

1947- The United States during this time launched the Marshall plan in order to set up a mechanism to provide funding to the European countries affected by the war. It also provided loans for infrastructure building and development loans for developing countries. Its first non-European loan was to Chile in 1948 as it mainly focused its funding on European countries

1950s- Around this time the World Bank focused its approach on developing countries for infrastructure, agricultural, and technical assistance however during this time it also became clear that it was very difficult for extremely poor countries to get loans under the IBRD

1960- Around this time the World Bank created the International Development Association (IDA) which was created mainly to focus on more poorer countries and their development initiatives expanding the World Bank's role in developing countries and now made the institution important for lower income countries

1960s-1970s- In this era of decolonization the World Bank saw a surge of new countries especially developing ones join the institution in masses increasing the role of developing countries in the World Bank however these newly joined countries were still only given basic votes and their growing economies meant gaining share votes wasn't easy

1970s- The war between Israel and Arab states increased and hence several members of the Organization of the Petroleum Exporting Countries (OPEC) imposed an oil embargo on countries who generally favoured Israel in the war. This caused a massive surge in the prices of oil throughout the world and hence the developing countries had to increasingly take loans from IMF during this time period increasing their dependence on the IMF and World Bank

1971- The United States in 1971 ended the dollar's convertibility into gold, which caused the fixed exchange rate system at Bretton Woods Institutions to effectively collapse and hence the IMF eventually adapted to more flexible exchange rates

1980s- In the 1980s many countries were struggling to pay external debts and hence during this time interest rates significantly grew which caused significant economic problems for developing countries who were already struggling to pay off the debts and now had to deal with the increased interest rates. To help with this problem the IMF and World Bank stepped in and helped make policy recommendations and provide financial recommendations to these global south countries proving to be greatly effective during this time period

1980s-1990s- Around this time the IMF and World Bank changed their structure regarding loans and financial assistance. The loans these institutions now gave required the countries to improve their economic policies by reducing government deficits, reforming state-owned enterprises and changing subsidies etc. While some viewed these changes as necessary and a

good step others argued that these reforms impacted the local people and in one way or another would burdenize the local population

1990s- The world generally saw an increase in trade and international investments making the already developed economies develop even more while the developing countries struggled to keep up with the ever increasing share votes the developed countries were getting effectively decreasing their representation in the World Bank

1990s-2000s- Around this time the developing countries began calling for a change in the governance system of the IMF and World Bank arguing that in previous times the economic balance was different from what it is now

2008- A global financial crisis took place causing many countries throughout the world to suffer economically so the World Bank increased its fundings and financial commitments

2010- In 2010 the World Bank had a major reform in its voting system where the IBRD capitals increased and the share votes of developing countries increased by 3.13% getting to 47.19%. The reforms also ordered for frequent reviews of the shareholdings done by the World Bank.

2010s- In 2010s once again the world saw an increase in economic disparity throughout the world as developed countries continued to grow massively and during this time some new major stakeholders in the World Bank also emerged in the form of India, China and Brazil because of their rising economies.

2020s-Current times- Nowadays the debate between whether the World Bank voting system is fair or not continues to rage on as many argue that these countries have significant economic contributions to the World Bank and hence deserve the massive number of share votes while some argue that representation should be more balanced especially for developing countries as those countries are the ones that are most affected by the policies set by the World Bank and the IMF.

Voting Power and Representation Mechanics and Core Problems

1. How weighted voting works (capital subscription-based)

The general principle behind the voting system is basic votes, which a country obtains by simply being a part of the World Bank, and shared votes, which a country obtains based on factors like the country's economy and financial contribution to the World

Bank. This means that countries with a stronger economy generally have more voting power and hence better representation in the World Bank's decision-making.

Basic votes: These are the votes in the World Bank annual and spring meetings that every country obtains by simply being a part of the World Bank, and in comparison to share votes, these basic votes are way fewer in number.

Share votes: These are exclusive votes for countries given based on factors like a country's GDP and its financial contribution to the World Bank. These votes form the majority of the World Bank's votes.

Capital Subscription: Capital subscription is the amount of money a country is willing to give to the World Bank on an annual basis, and capital subscription is one of the most important factors in deciding how many share votes a country gets.

General Capital Increase: General Capital Increase is an ordeal given by the World Bank that authorizes countries to give more capital to the World Bank, effectively increasing the World Bank's overall capital to work with, which can help in increased loans and better help countries during major crisis situations.

When the World Bank was first established in 1944, it gave representation to countries based on their income, reserves, and trade volume at the very time it was created. The problem that arises is that most of the Global South countries were then under the colonial rule of mainly Britain, France, and the Netherlands. The countries that were not under colonial rule had newly gained independence from it and were not economically strong at that point, creating an inequality from the creation of the very World Bank.

Since the shares are tied to how much capital a country could contribute, developing nations cannot buy more voting power, even if they absolutely wanted to, keeping the system inclined towards the wealthier states by design. The very capital developing nations lacked was taken from them by colonizers when they left the country; with capital resources like minerals and resources, this left the developing nations with a disadvantage from the very start.

Wealth-based voting leads to a "pay-to-play" system because votes are tied to capital contributions rather than population or need. In both the IMF and the World Bank, countries with historically more wealth from industrialization, colonial extraction, and early capital markets automatically retain more power, meaning the socio-economic gap that colonialism created is now locked in as political power and still proceeds to exist even after 82 years of the Bank's creation.

2. The 85% supermajority threshold and what it structurally enables (veto-by-math)

A super voting majority means that 85% of the shareholders have to agree. This gives nations with larger thresholds a lot more say in the voting of a structural say. Any single large shareholder holds the authority of geopolitical realignment of power, which is only possible with the consent of those who already hold it. Which is very unlikely, as no nation would willingly submit its power to another nation.

Uruguay recently approved a \$300 million loan, which shows how the bank is unfazed about the representation struggle and still approves loans through an unreformed voting structure, showing the unwillingness of the power holders to negotiate.

Moving on, nations like the USA, Japan, and China have a huge say in how the voting proceeds. Furthermore, bigger blocs like the G7 bloc effectively have veto power, as they hold more than 15% of the voting power. Adding on, the USA alone has the veto power, as they hold more than 15% of the voting power. This solidifies the USA having more voting power than any other nation and more voting power than any other bloc alone.

3. Current voting share breakdown-US, EU bloc, China, and Global South aggregate share

- I. G7 Countries-Consists of the US, UK, Germany, France, Japan, Italy, and Canada. Major shareholders with substantial voting power and long-standing influence within the Bretton Woods system. They represent an integral part of the Bretton Woods governance structure, and they control roughly 38-40% of the total voting power in the World Bank. This makes the alliance a crucial part and a must-vote to pass anything within the very institutions.
- II. BRICS Nations-It consists of Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa. These nations have about 13-14% of the total voting power in the World Bank, even though they represent about 40% of the total global population. BRICS are the major emerging economies from the Global South. They especially play the most important role, as they are the realistic representatives of the Global South as the time stands.
- III. African States-It consists of Nigeria, South Africa, Kenya, Egypt, Ethiopia, Ghana, and 49 other member states. African nations represent a great majority of the Global South and have had very minimal representation in their voting power to their population ratio. As of now these nations have 10-11% voting power in the World Bank. African countries are also major recipients of World Bank financing. These countries staying together means that they actually get representation to some extent in the Bretton institutions.

- IV. European States-It consists of the Netherlands, Spain, Belgium, Sweden, Norway, Denmark, and around 25 more member states. Basically all of the non-G7 European nations. These nations hold about 16-18% of voting power in the World Bank. However, these nations only account for 5.7% of the global population. This shows that these countries get more recognition when compared to their population and needs. Many of these nations participate in the institutions through multi-country constituencies on the Board of Executive Directors. Even though individual nations barely have any voting power, when they form an alliance together, they become an integral part.
- V. Least Developed Countries-It consists of Bangladesh, Ethiopia, Nepal, Haiti, and 40 other nations. These nations only have about 4% of the voting power in the World Bank. These nations represent about 14% of the global population, which means that they are relatively underrepresented according to their population. This often results in their needs and cases going under the shadow of the nations holding the majority of the voting powers. LDCs are countries classified by the UN as having low levels of income and significant structural development challenges. These nations are highly dependent on these institutions' financing, and with little representation, they are often not offered many concessions.
- VI. Small Island Developing States-It consists of the Maldives, Fiji, Barbados, and about 35 other nations. These nations only have a 1-2% voting power in the World Bank. These nations nearly make up 1% of the global population, which means that their representation in the population ratio is quite fair. However, the numerical number is still too low for them to properly represent their issue in the World Bank.
- VII. Landlocked Developing Countries - It consists of Bolivia, Mongolia, Chad and about 30 other nations. These countries represent approximately 7.4% of the world's population, with their World Bank voting power determined individually rather than through a collective LLDC allocation.
- VIII. Gulf States-It consists of Saudi Arabia, UAE, Qatar, Kuwait, Bahrain, and Oman. These nations have about 3.5-4% voting power in the World Bank, while they represent about 1% of the total global population.
- IX. Nordic States-It consists of Norway, Sweden, Denmark, Finland, and Iceland. These states have about 2.5% of the voting power in the World Bank, while they only consist of 0.35% of the total global population, but that is mainly due to the fact that most of their lands are uninhabitable.

In 2008-2010 the World Bank announced a shift in their voting shares, and some banks claimed that the voting shares of these poor countries rose from 33.41% all the way to 39.48%; however, other figures might suggest otherwise, and it is to be noted that African countries barely benefited from these reforms.

In 2010 the World Bank had a major reform in its voting system where the IBRD capitals increased and the share votes of developing countries increased by 3.13%, getting to 47.19%.

4. Executive Director allocation imbalance (single-country EDs vs. shared multi-country EDs for large African blocs)

The relatively poorer countries have to get together to represent a single seat in the World Bank; this means that their geopolitical voice is limited, and many of their issues might not be discussed due to their lack of representation in the institutions.

Many of these nations [European states] participate in the institutions through multi-country constituencies on the Board of Executive Directors. Even though individual nations barely have any voting power, when they form an alliance together, they become an integral part.

There are a total of 25 executive directors, representing 189 member states. This shows that these directors are often divided very unevenly in the matter of representation of each geographical area. In context, 45 African nations are represented by 2 executive directors, which, compared to wealthier nations, one executive director per country seems very unfair to the African nations.

The third and final executive director represents only 3 nations: Angola, Nigeria, and South Africa. This shows the inconsistency in the representation as well. As the first Executive Director represents 23 countries, the second Executive Director represents 22 countries, and the third represents only 3 countries, showing that the countries with slightly better economies do get better representation and showing representation isn't need-based.

This issue, however, is not only limited to African nations. Countries like Bangladesh, Nepal, and Sri Lanka share a single ED, while Japan holds its own seat, and in Latin America and the Caribbean, small island states are often grouped with far larger middle-income economies. This results in the concerns of smaller nations getting diluted just because of lack of representation.

5. The unwritten convention of an American World Bank President / European IMF head

Leadership conventions across both institutions reflect a mutual power-sharing arrangement between the same dominant blocs, meaning top leadership in both organizations has remained concentrated among the same group of countries for decades, simultaneously limiting Global South access to senior institutional authority in either body. This means that the Bretton Woods institutions (IMF and World Bank) both have had a similar power structure, and the power is divided among the same nations and blocs.

The current leader for the World Bank is selected through a nomination and voting system; however, generally it has been an unprecedented rule that the US selects the leader for the World Bank, and so this could be fixed by introducing a properly governed system to elect the World Bank's leader. On the other hand, it could also be argued that this unprecedented rule was not all an accident. All the way back in 1944, British economist John Maynard Keynes had expected American official Harry Dexter White to lead the IMF; however, the US suspected Harry Dexter to have ties with the Soviets, and hence, the US Treasury Secretary instead chose a different candidate, all due to the heat of the Cold War.

A case study on this unprecedented rule could be the 2012 election campaign fought by Nigerian Finance Minister Ngozi Okonjo-Iweala, who gave incredible speeches and was widely respected. He was also backed by the official South African government, and it looked as if this time the election for the manager of the World Bank would be won by a non-US candidate; however, as it turns out, the US-backed candidate ended up winning the elections due to the same old voting system in the IMF based on contribution and shares in the IMF. The losing candidate also called this very unfair and reportedly said that if this keeps on going, this could cause a democratic deficit in global governance.

The BRICS New Delhi Declaration (2026) supports the 2025 Shareholding Review as a way to fix what it calls the "historic underrepresentation" of developing countries while calling for a fair, transparent, and merit-based leadership system instead of historical authorities over the World Bank.

It is also to be noted that the nature of the unprecedented law is rather unofficial, and hence there is no way for the countries to challenge this law, as there is no constitution or legal document for this rule.

6. Washington Consensus/conditionality legacy, including SAPs

1980s-1990s- Around this time the IMF and World Bank changed their structure regarding loans and financial assistance. The loans these institutions now gave required the countries to improve their economic policies by reducing government deficits, reforming state-owned enterprises, changing subsidies, etc. While some viewed these changes as necessary and a good step, others argued that these reforms impacted the local people and in one way or another would burden them.

1980s- In the 1980s many countries were struggling to pay external debts, and hence during this time interest rates significantly grew, which caused significant economic problems for developing countries that were already struggling to pay off the debts and now had to deal with the increased interest rates. To help with this problem, the IMF and World Bank stepped in and helped make policy recommendations and provide financial recommendations to these global south countries, proving to be greatly effective during this time period.

When rich countries gave loans through the World Bank, they sometimes attached conditions that happened to match what those rich countries wanted politically or economically, not particularly in the interest of the country receiving the loans. These conditions are known as SAPs. The loans themselves became a diplomatic tool instead of a development policy. The very method caused the poor countries to not have a significant voice in the institution, as they were submitted to follow an unwritten agreement for taking a loan.

For loans handed out by the World Bank and IMF, the conditions are written by these institutions. These conditions could include cutting spending on certain sectors of the country, for example, healthcare or education. These conditions could in many cases not be ideal for the country's economy, as reducing spending on certain sectors could result in huge economic losses, and overall these conditions aren't ideal for the country's overall dynamics as well.

Over the years even when time to time reforms have taken place we have seen that repeatedly these reforms on paper despite seeming adequate in reality only affect middle-income countries and at the end of the day the truly poor-countries are still left unaddressed and without reforms this all leads to a system forming where when a greater say by poorer countries is asked for the middle-income countries are the ones who majorly get addressed and hence the economies of the poor-countries would continue to suffer immensely. In addition, it is important to note that the loan policies and interest rates decided on by the World Bank and the IMF in some cases might be way harsher than the countries truly deserve and hence taking a loan instead of improving their economy could end up making it even worse.

Furthermore, when countries in the past took loans from the World Bank and IMF in order to pay the loans back, these countries were instructed to cut back their spending on things like healthcare, education, and other subsidies in order to save up money to repay those loans. This in turn heavily impacts the local citizens, as they are the ones who bear the brunt of this debt, and their basic facilities are taken away from them. This may also cause resentment within the population, and anti-national sentiments could also develop within the people.

7. SDR allocation inequity & surveillance asymmetry

Special Drawing Rights (SDRs) are a type of reserve asset created by the IMF. Its value is decided based on a basket of five currencies: the US dollar, the Euro, the Chinese yuan, the Japanese yen, and the British pound, where these currencies are then mixed together to give value to these SDRs. These SDRs are, in essence, free money for a country because these do not count as debt, and neither do they have any conditions. The SDRs can be part of a country's foreign currency reserve, or they can be exchanged with countries for actual usable money, which can be used by the country.

The allocation system for SDRs is based on a need-based assessment carried out by the IMF. This SDR allocation does not occur on a regular basis but rather needs a global trigger for the IMF, for example, a global crisis or a situation where the IMF deems that a genuine long-term global need for assets is needed. Once that need is identified, the Managing Director of the IMF makes a proposal for how large the assets are to be, which is then presented to the Executive Board. The rule for the SDRs getting accepted is that a country member of the IMF holding 85% or above voting shares in the council approves whether or not the SDRs are appropriate, and since the USA currently is the only country to have those massive voting shares, it gets to approve whether or not an SDR passes.

The committee then sits together to decide a figure in actual currency for the allocation of SDRs; for example, in 2021 this figure came out to be 650 billion USD. After the general figure is decided, the money is then split between countries based on their IMF quota share, so in essence countries with more wealth get even wealthier through these SDRs, while poorer countries tend to get lesser SDR allocations.

On the other hand, the IMF doesn't just hand out loans to countries; it actually regularly checks up on these loans being managed by the country through the form of surveillance. This process is formally called an Article IV consultation, and this is an annual review done by IMF staff where they review the country's economic policies. The same staff then goes on to write a review report of how good the country's economic situation is and how it should go on to fix it. However, the process of surveillance in countries is not considered fair by many standards, as the reports for lower-income countries are way stricter than those for higher-income countries, with a large share in the IMF. Furthermore, the poorer countries are forced to abide by the plan handed out by the IMF to fix their problems, while the wealthier countries can choose to ignore these suggestions and treat them more as advice rather than actual instructions.

Reform Timeline - Why It Keeps Stalling

a. 14th-17th GRQ history

The 14th review was agreed in 2010 but was implemented in 2016. In this the IMF quotas doubled and 6 percentage points shifted towards emerging market and developing economies. This reform made China the third largest voting power holder. Even this took 6 years to implement as this had to be approved by US Congressional, showing even how a legitimate reform can be undermined due to the sheer authority a single nation holds over the institutions.

The 15th review was concluded in 2020, in which zero increase in quotas took place and none of the voting power was transferred to/from any nation at all. This proved a complete stall in any reforms made by the world bank also proven by the World Bank's own 2020 Shareholding Review. Overall this review is deemed to have achieved nothing at all.

The 16th Review was concluded at the end of 2023. This review approved a 50% equiproportional increase in quotas, however, this affected the relative voting share by 0% which means that no effective power was transferred at all. The equiproportional increase meant that every nation's voting power went up by 50%, this means that the reform had no effect at all, making the 16th review useless as well with adding a reform just for the sake of adding a reform.

The 17th Review was first supposed to be conducted in December of 2025, but an extension led to the review being pushed back to 2028. In this review, it is being attempted that an actual formula be made to decide how much voting power a nation gets, not just merely increasing the amount of money in the system. This matters a lot since this issue is untouched since the creation of the world bank back in 1944. So this reforms effectively wants to change how the 16th review 0 change policy does not repeat.

b. The veto dynamic in practice:

The Best Example of the Veto Dynamic is the The 2017 Capital Increase Standoff. In 2017, then-World Bank President Jim Yong Kim pushed for a capital increase, noting the "vast majority" of the Bank's 189 members supported it. The US Treasury publicly said it was "too soon" to discuss it, arguing too much of IBRD's balance sheet was going to countries, explicitly naming China, that already had ample borrowing capacity elsewhere.

The Capital Increase didn't happen till 2018 when the US got concessions it wanted including a graduation policy pushing higher-income borrowers like China toward paying more/borrowing less, and pricing changes discouraging middle-income countries from over-relying on IBRD.

c. 2010 and 2018 voice/shareholding reforms - what changed, how much, and why critics call it insufficient

The 2008 global financial crisis revealed to the world how dependent countries had become on emerging powers like China, India and Brazil for growth. This put an increasing amount of pressure on the IMF to reform its representation system, especially by the G20. Hence due to this pressure both the World Bank and the IMF brought their own reforms.

The World Bank's reforms increased the voting shares for developing countries by 3.13% bringing the total up to 47.19%. Furthermore, the World Bank increased its capital pool by 3.5 billion USD this meant that more countries had the opportunity to

now buy more shares in the World Bank and generally increase their voting shares. Additionally, the World Bank also increased its capital by a further 1.6 billion USD which was a selective capital pool only available for growing underdeveloped countries through which China massively rose in power in the World Bank.

The IMF had similar reforms set mainly focused on giving undeveloped countries more voting rights and consolidated European representation on the executive board. However, since any reform to be passed in the IMF requires approval by national legislatures the US congress delayed the passing of the reforms by 6 years and in 2016 these reforms passed.

The critics argued that despite the 3.13% rise in voting shares the developed countries still massively held the majority and so the reforms were deemed rather insufficient. Furthermore, the world bank claimed that the voting shares increased significantly however the distribution of this increase was very disproportionate as many African countries barely saw an increase and so did not benefit from these reforms at all.

In 2018 the Capital increase did happen (This is what the US objected to in 2017) with \$60.1 billion IBRD capital increase. The capital increase and the voting-share reallocation were negotiated as a package meaning that countries agreed to inject fresh capital, and in exchange, shares were reshuffled slightly.

China's shareholding rose to 5.71%, keeping it the third-largest shareholder just behind Japan, which was set to hold 6.83% of total voting power once the reforms took effect.

1. Scale mismatch with actual economic shifts: China, India, and Indonesia (three of the world's four most populous nations) remain dramatically underrepresented relative to their share of global GDP, even after 2018.
2. The US retained its blocking position throughout
3. Pattern Repeated: the 2015 review before it produced only a non-binding statement of principles (the "Lima Principles") with no actual vote shift; the 2020 review that followed produced no change at all; and the next scheduled round (2025) has already been described by observers as stalled again over the same US-China rivalry dynamics that constrained 2018.

Current Global Situation

The main reform process is called the "Fourth Shareholding Review", which is the World Bank's own check on how the voting power is shared between the member states. The 2025

Shareholding Review, was supposed to be the World Bank's biggest reform, but the very awaited review just shifted 0.5% more voting power when compared to 2020.

Voting power is based on how much money a country puts in, not how big its economy is today. When the bank was first established, it assessed the assets and economies of countries then, even though the countries have grown a lot economically they still do not get the representation that they deserve.

The bank has previously tried to give more representation to developing countries previously in 2010 and 2018 but the developed countries have no plan of power sharing.

The USA is explicitly resisting any meaningful increase to China's shareholding, fearing it would give Beijing more influence over the Bank; many European shareholders quietly back this resistance too. As China currently has less rights because when the bank was formed China was not as strong of an economy as it is now.

BRICS New Delhi Declaration (2026) supports the 2025 Shareholding Review as a way to fix what it calls the "historic underrepresentation" of developing countries, while calling for a fair, transparent and merit based leadership system instead of historical authorities over the World Bank.

Uruguay was recently approved a \$300 million loan, which shows how the bank is unfazed about the representation struggle and still approves loans through an unreformed voting structure, showing unwillingness of the power holders to negotiate.

Root Causes of Structural underrepresentation of the Global South in Bretton Woods institutions

The structural underrepresentation of the Global South in Bretton Woods institutions cannot be attributed to a single cause. Rather, it has developed through the interaction of socio-economic, geo-political and institutional factors that have evolved over decades. Although the experiences of individual developing nations differ across regions, many of the underlying drivers remain similar. Colonial era capital structures, post-war institutional design, unequal voting formulas, debt dependency, and the concentration of technical and leadership authority in the Global North have collectively contributed to the gradual erosion of the Global South's voice in global economic governance. Consequently, understanding these interconnected root causes is essential for developing long term and equitable reforms that protect institutional legitimacy while supporting inclusive global development.

Social Causes

When the World Bank was first established in 1944, it gave representation to countries based on their income, reserves, and trade volume at the very time it was created. The problem that arises is that most of the Global South countries were then under the colonial rule of mainly Britain, French and Dutch. The countries which were not under colonial rule had newly gained independence from it and were not economically strong at that point creating an inequality from the creation of the very World Bank.

Over 2006–2015, US nationals alone held about 16% of all World Bank staff positions far outweighing countries like India at just 6%, despite India's much larger population. This showed that the very staff that are implementing the policies are trained in the Global North institutions, which results in the conditions of the loan seemingly fair to the drafters but much harsher to the people of the Global South since they have far too little representation.

Official Bank documentation, negotiations, and technical reports have historically been done in English and French. This disadvantages nations that do not speak these languages, primarily in the Global South, so this limits their ability to participate as equals in technical discussions. As the representatives might not be as proficient in the aforementioned languages which means that not only they have less of a say but what they say is also limited by language constraints.

In developing nations, either the media coverage is very limited or the media coverage is propaganda based by the government, this means weaker civil society infrastructure around global finance issues have meant less domestic public pressure on governments to actively push for institutional reform. This compared to the Global North's media coverage which is a lot better with monitoring policies, which makes sure normal people are heard.

Skilled professionals from developing countries who could have advocated for their nations interests within these institutions frequently emigrated and became citizens of Global North countries, this results in valuable future representatives of a country to be lost because of lack of opportunity in the native country. This also decreases the pool of experts a nation has that could negotiate on a global level, specifically in the Bretton Woods institutions.

Economic Causes

Global South countries are the Bank's exclusive borrowers which means that they enter the very agreement to taking a loan at a grave disadvantage. This means that they have little to no chance of bargaining, which results in high interest rates and the loans on Global South to increase and pressurise their economy to an extent that they could no longer bear the burden and go in debt. This also leads to the Global South states with less bargaining power to demand voting reform, since donor states control both the purse and the rules and because multiple Global South nations had to represent a single seat.

Post World War 2, the Bank's very first mission was solidified as rebuilding the war torn Europe, rather than rebuilding the colonies of the very European nations or the poorer countries in the Global South. The very establishment of the Bank hence became a cause of why the Global South was under represented in the future.

Wealth based voting leads to a "pay-to-play" system because votes are tied to capital contributions rather than population or need in both the IMF and the World Bank, countries with historically more wealth from industrialization, colonial extraction, and early capital markets automatically retain more power meaning the socio-economic gap that colonialism created is now locked in as political power, and still proceeds to exist even after 82 years of the Bank's creation.

Since the shares are tied to how much capital a country could contribute, developing nations can not buy more voting power, even if they absolutely wanted to, keeping the system inclined towards the wealthier states by design. The very capital developing nations lack was taken from them by colonisers when they left the country, with capital resources like minerals and resources, this left the developing nations with a disadvantage from the very start.

The Global South focuses on exporting raw materials out to gain capital, which is very ineffective and inefficient when compared to exporting the finished/ processed goods. This results in slow economic growth which is also volatile. This slow growth directly affects the capital contributions which in future affects their voting power

Geopolitical Causes

The founding era marked the formation of the power blocs. Immediately after World War 2, the greatest economic and military countries took over the largest number of voting shares, this formed a geopolitical hierarchy from the creation of the World Bank. The root cause of why this persisted was that the institution lacked the evolving of shares more regularly and even when it did, the change was relatively un-noticeable.

The cold war alignment has also played a major part in deciding, which countries will be given development support, technical assistance, or political backing, as a part of the ideological rivalry between nations and blocs. Those old political relationships still influence how some countries are treated by the institution even now.

Leadership conventions across both institutions reflect a mutual power sharing arrangement between the same dominant blocs meaning top leadership in both organizations has remained concentrated among the same group of countries for decades, simultaneously limiting Global South access to senior institutional authority in either body. This means that the Bretton Woods institutions(IMF and World Bank) both have had a similar power structure and the power is divided among the same nations and blocs.

Countries with more natural resources and Global trade routes got more attention early on. Nations that had valuable natural resources (like oil or minerals) or sat on important trade paths were given more focus and negotiating power by the powerful shareholder countries. This shows how the institution was based on what resources a country had and not what resources a country needs.

Political Causes

The relatively poorer countries have to get together to represent a single seat in the World Bank, this means that their geopolitical voice is limited and many of their issues might not be discussed due to their lack of representation in the institutions. This means that the Global South

Super voting Majority means that 85% of the shareholders have to agree. This gives nations with larger thresholds a lot more say in the voting of a structural say. Any single large shareholder holds the authority of geopolitical realignment of power, which is only possible with the consent of those who already hold it. Which is very unlikely as no nation would willingly submit its power for another nation.

When rich countries gave loans through the World Bank, they sometimes attached conditions that happened to match what those rich countries wanted politically or economically, not particularly in the interest of the country receiving the loans. The loans itself became a way of diplomatic tool instead.

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When rich countries gave loans through the World Bank, they sometimes attached conditions that happened to match what those rich countries wanted politically or economically, not particularly in the interest of the country receiving the loans. The loans itself became a way of diplomatic tool instead of a development policy. The very method caused the poor countries to not have a significant voice in the institution, as they were submitted to follow an unwritten agreement for taking a loan.

Impacts:

Social impacts:

For each country in this world in order to design a new development project multiple local factors have to be taken into consideration that are not well known by other countries so when the developed countries in the World Bank design projects for the developing countries they are often very far from reality and create unrealistic projects without taking into consideration the local factors so the projects often end up failing when they are actually implemented. Furthermore, when countries in the past took loans from the World Bank and IMF in order to pay the loans back these countries were instructed to cut back their spending on things like healthcare, education, and other subsidies in order to save up money to repay those loans. This in turn heavily impacts the local citizens as they are the ones who bear the brunt of this debt and their basic facilities are taken away from them. This may also cause resentment within the population and anti national sentiments could also develop within the people.

Most representatives in the World Bank and IMF are also in most cases rich wealthy politicians who are in most cases men so it can be argued that only certain individuals cannot be the voice for an entire country as groups like women, religions and the poor people can have their opinions ignored or not represented properly. This can cause the needs of these groups to go unnoticed and hence hinder any success for the project while also marginalizing these groups.

Additionally, when the developing or global south countries are repeatedly dictated on what to do and the economic policies for them they slowly start losing trust in these institutions. This can become increasingly a factor amongst the local citizens as they start to lose trust in the institutions due to their lack of say and bad policies which may simply be due to negligence. This can cause people and countries to negate or doubt any future plans even for important agendas such as climate change and pandemics making international cooperation in such dire circumstances very difficult.

When countries don't make their own economic policy it can also cause severe dependency of these countries on these institutions which can hinder any real structural developments in their economic systems as the people and government repeatedly have no say in the policymaking. Furthermore, repeated loans from these countries without success in development projects can also lead to a cycle of repeated loans taken from these institutions which can also become a burden for the World Bank and IMF.

Economic impacts:

For loans handed out by the World Bank and IMF the conditions are written by these institutions. These conditions could include cutting spending on certain sectors of the country for example healthcare or education. These conditions could in many cases not be ideal for the country's economy as reducing spending on certain sectors could result in huge economic losses and overall these conditions aren't ideal for the country's overall dynamics as well.

Additionally, even if we consider the argument for more share votes based on economic contributions and overall economy to be valid it should still spark concerns that even developed and strong economies with high capitals invested in the World Bank such as India and China do not have enough say in the World Bank.

Over the years even when time to time reforms have taken place we have seen that repeatedly these reforms on paper despite seeming adequate in reality only affect middle-income countries and at the end of the day the truly poor-countries are still left unaddressed and without reforms this all leads to a system forming where when a greater say by poorer countries is asked for the middle-income countries are the ones who majorly get addressed and hence the economies of the poor-countries would continue to suffer immensely. In addition, it is important to note that the loan policies and interest rates decided on by the World Bank and the IMF in some cases might be way harsher than the countries truly deserve and hence taking a loan instead of improving their economy could end up making it even worse.

In international projects and trade deals the richer countries and multinational companies could actually impose incredibly harsh terms on the poorer countries due to the lack of institutional backing that the poor countries receive making their case in negotiation weaker and hence making unfair terms more likely simply due to the overall position the countries hold.

Political impacts:

Due to the poorer Asian and African countries being repeatedly ignored by the reforms of the World Bank and IMF these countries have moved away from these centralized institutions and have instead formed their own institutions such as BRICS bank and Asian infrastructure investment bank which make international cooperation under one body difficult especially due to the rise in population of these competing bodies. Some countries often don't abide to the policies and recommendations of World Bank either just because they feel their opinions and voices are left out and not heard properly which actually significantly decreases the sphere of influence of the World Bank and the IMF

Due to the power imbalance of the World Bank and IMF many countries often have to force themselves into alliances with developed countries so that their interests are preserved. These alliances aren't always favourable for the developing countries as the developed countries force their own terms on the developing countries due to their superior position in the Bretton woods institutions. This leads to factions being created in the world where smaller countries are forced to either abide to the unfavourable terms of the world bank or ally themselves with powerful countries to protect their interests.

Humanitarian impacts:

Many countries, especially the underdeveloped ones, are regularly given climate funding in order to deal with the climate change situation. However, it is increasingly seen that the unrealistic expectations of the developed countries often leads to the funding majorly being directed towards reducing emissions and preserving the environment which on paper may seem nice but for third world countries this funding should realistically be aimed towards dealing with the climate change impacts and helping these countries adapt to the ever changing climate. In past events, it was also frequently noticeable that funding in crisis situations to poorer countries was substantially delayed compared to the wealthier countries whose funding was often prioritised in such situations.

The general policy of loans given out in emergency situations is also poor as these loans are almost entirely focused on dealing with the current crisis instead of spending a portion of that money on preventing any such future crisis. This leads to countries being unable to prevent future crises and the debt of these loans just keep on piling, ultimately increasing the country's dependency on foreign aid.

Many refugee ridden countries in the world are also not given the same priority that they should be. These countries do not get enough financial support to deal with the refugees at hand and hence face an incredible financial burden. Furthermore, countries that depend on imports can't decide the overall world's import policies and also can't control the World Bank's response to price hikes. This can be a major problem for countries who rely on importing food to feed their people as when poor policies and responses are made to international price hikes in food a massive food insecurity in these regions can be seen and the people often suffer from famines and starvation.

Key stakeholders and Bloc formations

G7 Countries

Consists of US, UK, Germany, France, Japan, Italy and Canada.

Major shareholders with substantial voting power and long standing influence within the Bretton Woods system. They represent an integral part of the Bretton Woods governance structure, and they control roughly 38-40% of the total voting power in the World Bank. This makes the alliance a crucial part and a must vote to pass anything within the very institutions.

BRICS Nations

It consists of Brazil, Russia, India, China and South Africa. These nations have about 13-14% of the total voting power in the World Bank, even though they represent about 40% of the total global population. BRICS are the major emerging economies from the Global South.

They especially play the most important role as they are the realistic representatives of the Global South as the time stands.

African States

It consists of Nigeria, South Africa, Kenya, Egypt, Ethiopia, Ghana and 49 other member states. African nations represent a great majority of the Global South and have had very minimal representation in their voting power to their population ratio. As of now these nations have 10-11% voting power in the world bank. African countries are also major recipients of World Bank financing. These countries staying together means that they actually get representation to some extent in the Bretton institutions.

European States

It consists of the Netherlands, Spain, Belgium, Sweden, Norway, Denmark and around 25 more member states. Basically all of the non G7 European Nations. These nations hold about 16-18% of voting power in the World Bank. However, these nations only account for 5.7% of the global population. This shows that these countries get more recognition when compared to their population and needs. Many of these nations participate in the institutions through multi-country constituencies on the Board of Executive Directors. Even though individual nations barely have any voting power, when they form an alliance together they become an integral part.

Least Developed Countries

It consists of Bangladesh, Ethiopia, Nepal, Haiti and 40 other nations. These nations only have about 4% of the voting power in the World Bank. These nations represent about 14% of the Global population, which means that they are relatively under represented according to their population. This often results in their needs and cases to go under the shadow of the nations holding the majority of the voting powers. LDCs are countries classified by the UN as having low levels of income and significant structural development challenges. These nations are highly dependent on these institutions' financing and with little representation they are often not offered many concessions.

Small Island Developing States

It consists of Maldives, Fiji, Barbados and about 35 other nations. These nations only have a 1-2% voting power in the World Bank. These Nations nearly make up 1% of the Global population, which means that their representation to population ratio is quite fair. However, the numerical number is still too low for them to properly represent their issue in the World Bank. These are small developing countries with particular economic and geographic vulnerabilities. Many face high exposure to climate-related disasters, limited domestic markets and difficulties accessing affordable financing. Their basic job is the representation of Island Nations with small economies.

Landlocked Developing Countries

It consists of Bolivia, Mongolia, Chad and about 30 other nations. These countries represent approximately 7.4% of the world's population, with their World Bank voting power determined individually rather than through a collective LLDC allocation. Since these nations are landlocked they do not have access to the sea, severely affecting their economies that could have earned through trade through sea routes. Since the transport cost are very high these Nations rely on international development financing for infrastructure and economic development.

Gulf States

It consists of Saudi Arabia, UAE, Qatar, Kuwait, Bahrain and Oman. These nations have about 3.5-4% voting power in the World Bank, while they represent about 1% of the total Global population. These Nations hold substantial resources and are often the investors and the development partners. Their role adds the perspective of financially influential developing and emerging economies whose interests do not always fit neatly into traditional categories such as "donor" or "borrower."

Fragile and Post-Conflict States

It consists of nations that have been recently a part of a conflict such as, South Sudan, Afghanistan, Syria. These Nations do not necessarily have a voting percentage nor are the nations that are included in this category specified. These nations are on the receiving end, as they have recently been in a conflict and so they need funds for the reconstruction of infrastructure and they need funds to gain political stability as well. Their role in this issue relates to the representation of countries with some of the highest development financing needs.

Nordic States

It consists of Norway, Sweden, Denmark, Finland and Iceland. These states have about 2.5% of the voting power in the World Bank, while they only consist of 0.35% of the total Global population, but that is mainly due to the fact that most of their lands are inhabitable. These countries have established and good economies and basically have the role of building a bridge between the donors and the receivers. These nations also have a long history of being an active part of institutions like international development cooperation and multilateral institutions.

Past UN actions:

- 1974 UN general assembly resolution on new international economic order: This resolution called for a better equitable economic system in place and more importantly it was one of the first resolutions to call out for an improved voting system in the World Bank and better representation of poorer countries
- 2002 Monterrey Consensus (UN International Conference on Financing for Development): This resolutions also formally called for better representation of under developed and developing nations in the World Bank
- 2015 Addis Ababa Action Agenda (Third Financing for Development Conference): Reaffirmed Monterrey Consensus's call for better representation
- SDG Target 10.6 (2015, Sustainable Development Goals): This SDG highlighted a goal for better voting rights for poorer countries and broader representation in institutions such as the World Bank and the IMF
- 2024 UN Summit of the Future & the "Pact for the Future": Called for reforms in the financial institutions
- 2025 Fourth International Conference on Financing for Development (Seville, Spain): This conference focused on improving debt frameworks, global financing policies and general financial assistance in developmental projects

World Bank internal reforms:

- In 2008-2010 the World Bank announced a shift in their voting shares and some banks claimed that the voting shares of these poor countries raised from 33.41% all the way to 39.48% (2008) ,however, it is to be noted that African countries barely benefited from these reforms
- 2010 IMF Quota and Governance Reform: This reform aimed at transferring some of the voting power to developing economies such as India, China and Brazil however this reform was delayed due to the approval of national legislatures including the US congress required so this reform passed 6 years late in 2016.
- 2018 World Bank shareholding review: caused a mere 0.5% rise in voting shares
- 2020 World Bank shareholding review: No results produced
- 2025 World Bank shareholding review: This review is currently ongoing and is considered as a very important review as countries like China and India aim to "correct the imbalances" through these reviews

Times the System Proved Helpful

1. Postwar reconstruction:

The Bretton Woods system as a whole has infact provided a period of monetary stability. The Bank issued its inaugural loan of \$250 million to France in 1947 to finance infrastructure projects. The loan was for \$106 million for equipment, \$180 million for coal and petroleum products, and \$214 million for raw materials - targeted

at rebuilding the steel industry and transport system. Similar reconstruction loans followed to the Netherlands, Denmark, and Luxembourg in 1947.

2. Crisis lending track record:

- a. 1980s Latin American Debt Crisis (triggered August 1982, Mexico default threat): The Bank and IMF jointly provided structural adjustment loans to Mexico, Argentina, Brazil, and others to avert a cascading sovereign default crisis. This was to prevent a disorderly collapse of the international financial system that a wave of simultaneous defaults could have triggered.
- b. 1997–98 Asian Financial Crisis: The Bank (alongside the IMF) provided emergency and structural adjustment financing to Indonesia, Thailand, and South Korea after currency collapses. This provided liquidity to stabilize currencies and banking sectors mid-collapse. However, this is heavily debated, and the conditionalities are questioned by critics.
- c. 2008–2010 Global Financial Crisis : World Bank Group financial commitments since July 2008 reached \$100 billion by April 2010 meaning the World Bank Group commitments rose from \$38.2 billion in FY2008 to \$58.8 billion in FY2009 to \$72.2 billion in FY2010. This received heavy procyclicality critique.

3. HIPC/MDRI debt relief:

HIPC Initiative: launched 1996, enhanced 1999

MDRI: launched at the G8 Gleneagles Summit, July 2005; implementation began 2006

Under MDRI, three multilateral institutions agreed to cancel 100% of eligible claims on countries that reached the HIPC "completion point": the IMF, IDA (World Bank), and the African Development Fund. More than 30 countries had received irrevocable debt cancellation under MDRI, with cumulative relief estimated at roughly \$75 billion in nominal terms when combined with HIPC. This genuinely freed up government budgets in dozens of the poorest countries (mostly Sub-Saharan Africa) from debt-service payments that were consuming resources otherwise needed for basic services.

4. COVID-19 pandemic:

The World Bank Group deployed over \$157 billion to fight the pandemic's health, economic, and social impacts, the largest crisis response of any such period in the Bank Group's history, an increase of more than 60% over the 15-month period prior to the pandemic. The Bank also played a key role in the G20's Debt Service Suspension Initiative (DSSI), established in May 2020, which delivered more than \$5 billion in debt relief to more than 40 participating countries. However, Vaccine-specific financing moved slower and smaller relative to the urgency , most of the truly instantaneous global liquidity relief in 2020 (SDR-adjacent swap lines, G7 central bank actions) came from elsewhere, not the Bank. The Bank's contribution was large but secondary to the immediate emergency phase; its comparative advantage was medium-term financing, not first-72-hours crisis response.

OARMA (Questions A Resolution Must Answer)

1. How to increase the representation of nations that are under-represented compared to their Global population percentage?
2. What specific criteria should determine voting share allocation going forward?
3. How to counter the super majority of 85% threshold, that currently allows major shareholders to veto reform?
4. How will the resolution ensure that the future shareholding review produces measurable changes in the voting power?
5. How will the resolution ensure that reforms remain adaptive to future shifts in global economic power, rather than being stuck in the past as the current state stuck in 1944?
6. Should executive board decisions and the voting records be made publicly available or should the records be in secrecy?
7. How should the resolution address the tension between capital-based voting and equity-based representation without undermining the Bank's financial credibility?
 - a. Should a hybrid formula weight both capital contribution AND population percentage, and if so, in what ratio?
 - b. Would shifting away from a purely capital-based system risk discouraging major shareholders from contributing further capital, and how should the resolution mitigate that risk?
 - c. Should there be a transition period where the new formula is phased in gradually rather than applied immediately?
8. What mechanism will prevent the resolution's reforms from stalling the way the 2015, 2018, and 2020 Shareholding Reviews did?
 - a. Should there be a mandatory, non-negotiable timeline for implementation rather than an open-ended structure?
 - b. Should an independent monitoring body be created to track compliance and report publicly on delays?
 - c. What consequences should apply to shareholders who block or indefinitely postpone agreed upon reforms?
9. Should the Global South Nations be given more seats in the executive board?
 - a. If yes then does the value of the seat in the executive board dilute or are the members replaced?
10. Should loan conditionalities be designed with recipient governments rather than imposed unilaterally, and what mechanism would ensure this?
 - a. If so, who would ensure that these mechanisms are being followed and the conditions are not being imposed by the donor?